

Medford School Committee
Regular Meeting - September 30, 2020
*****Executive Session 4:00-5:00 PM*****
Remote Meeting by ZOOM - 6:30 PM-Regular Meeting

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 22 and Verizon Channel 43 at 4:00 PM Executive Session and Regular Session at 6:30 P.M.

Executive Session Virtual Meeting Information - 4:00 PM

Since the meeting will be held remotely, participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

- (1) [Medford School Committee Meeting Executive Session on Zoom](#)
- (2) Telephone Information (choose any one of the following and then follow the prompts)
 - (a) 1-929-205-6099
 - (b) 1-312-626-6799
 - (c) 1-301-715-8592
 - (d) 1-346-248-7799
 - (e) 1-669-900-6833
 - (f) 1-253-215-8782
 - (i) Enter this meeting ID when prompted: 990 9078 2822

Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee Virtual Information - 6:30 PM

Since the meeting will be held remotely, participants can log or call in by using the following link or call-in number:

- (1) [Medford School Committee Meeting Regular Session on Zoom](#)
- (2) Telephone Information (choose any one of the following and then follow the prompts)
 - (a) 1-929-205-6099
 - (b) 1-312-626-6799
 - (c) 1-301-715-8592
 - (d) 1-346-248-7799
 - (e) 1-669-900-6833
 - (f) 1-253-215-8782
 - (i) Enter this meeting ID when prompted: 915 3101 7292

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

- 1) Your first and last name
- 2) Your Medford street address
- 3) Your question or comment

- I. Roll Call and Salute the Flag
- II. Approval of Minutes from September 16, 2020 School Committee Meeting
- III. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls
- IV. Report of Secretary
- V.. Report of Committees
 1. Rules, Policy & Equity Subcommittee - Paul Ruseau
Approval of Minutes from September 15, 2020 Subcommittee Meeting
 2. Behavioral Health & Special Education Subcommittee - Melanie McLaughlin
Approval of Minutes from September 17, 2020 Subcommittee Meeting
 3. Special Meeting-Committee of the Whole- Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn

Approval of Minutes from September 23, 2020

VI. Community Participation

Public Participation Emails: Questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

- 1) Your first and last name
- 2) Your Medford street address
- 3) Your question or comment

Jean Zotter-Parent

VII. Report of Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments
2. COVID-19 Public Health Update Report - Toni Wray and MaryAnn O'Connor
3. Recommendation to Approve Two Anonymous Donations to the Roberts School - Kirk Johnson & Andrew O'Brien
4. SY 2020 - 2021 Reopening & Hybrid Implementation Update
 - Report on Air Quality & Infrastructure Usage - David Murphy
 - Report on Class Size and Remote Learning - Suzanne Galusi
 - Report on Athletics Protocols amid COVID-19- Bobby Maloney & Dr. Peter Cushing

VIII. Old Business

- Motion to approve Resolution on the Disciplinary Practice of Suspension
- Motion that administration bring a policy recommendation and operations plan regarding the use of the Alpha Med app and until then we do not encourage people to email Ms. Wray.
- Motion that a tip sheet for Chromebook connectivity issues will be created and distributed before September 16 and a report of root cause will be provided to the School Committee by September 30th.

IX. Communications

X. New Business

1. The Rules, Policy & Equity Subcommittee will review and make recommendations prior to the creation of the 2021-2022 academic calendar on which holidays will be included.

Offered by Paul Ruseau

2. **Resolution for MPS Recognized School Holidays Yom Kippur and Juneteenth**

Whereas Medford Public Schools has made a publicly stated commitment to equity, diversity and inclusion

Whereas The City of Medford has recognized racism as a public health issue

Whereas on July 29, 2020 the state of Massachusetts recognized Juneteenth (June 19), a day commemorating the communication of emancipation of enslaved people as a state holiday and whereas 47 states and the District of Columbia recognize Juneteenth,

Whereas many holidays are observed in MA public schools in recognition of multiple faiths, ethnicities, races and backgrounds including (but not limited to) Columbus Day, Patriots Day, Presidents Day, Christmas Day, Martin Luther King, Jr. Day, Labor Day and others.

Be it resolved Medford Public Schools observe the holiest Jewish high holiday, Yom Kippur, as a recognized school holiday effective Thursday, September 16, 2021

Be it further resolved Medford Public Schools observe Juneteenth (June 19) as a school holiday effective June 19, 2021.

Offered by Melanie McLaughlin

3. **School Committee Resolution** for Notice to Students and Families receiving in-person classroom (hybrid) services via remote teaching with in person paraprofessional or proctor supervision.

- Whereas staffing accommodations via the Americans with Disabilities Act have limited some teaching staff to remote access
- Whereas families and students requested in-person learning through a staggered hybrid option assuming in-person instruction included in-person licensed educators
- Whereas families, staff and central administration could not accurately predict the number for in-person teachers needed based on in-person and remote teaching and learning accommodations pending

Be it resolved all students receiving remote teaching through in-person classroom instruction (staggered hybrid) with in-person proctor or paraprofessional support be notified in writing mailed home or via confirmed electronic receipt to families of the change in education and in-person staffing for in-person teaching and learning.

Be resolved that these mailed notices be translated into language of origin for non-English speaking families receiving remote teaching through in-person classroom settings with proctor or paraprofessional support.

Be it resolved that qualifications for classroom proctors are shared and communicated with students, families and staff.

Offered by Melanie McLaughlin

4. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the committee review, modify if necessary, and approve the final draft of the metrics plan. Be it further resolved that the dashboard be published each Thursday by 12 pm on the MPS website on the School Reopening tab. - *Offered by Jenny Graham*

5. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the school committee review, modify if necessary, and approve the final draft of the Fall Athletics guidelines and procedures developed for the Fall Conditioning Season. Be it further resolved that the guidelines and procedures be published on the MPS Website under the Athletics tab. Be it also resolved that the Athletics department provides a report to the committee no later than October 15th regarding Fall Conditioning enrollment and how the teams are doing as they adjust to new COVID-19 guidelines. - *Offered by Jenny Graham*

6. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that all Air Quality and Air Exchange reports be posted to the MPS website on the School Reopening tab. Be it further resolved that the tab also includes a summary of the metrics we have deemed appropriate in consultation with our experts so that the community understands how to interpret the data in the reports.- *Offered by Jenny Graham*

7. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the Communications, Engagement and Strategic Planning Committee begin a district-wide effort to develop a communications strategy roadmap that examines our current communications processes and technology systems used. Be it also resolved that the strategy work explores our efforts to reach all audiences, including families and staff within the district, and recommend improvements to increase our success. Be it also resolved that the strategy effort review the MPS website and recommend changes to improve the quality of the content therein. - *Offered by Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, and Melanie McLaughlin*
8. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the hybrid model be clearly defined at all grade levels for the community. Be it further resolved that the model description clearly outlines how the school day will operate for all students in all classrooms. Be it also resolved that this definition be provided no later than 9/30 for kindergarten, 10/5 for grades 1-12. - *Offered by Jenny Graham and Mea Mustone*
9. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the School Committee make a go or no-go decision at the Wednesday 9/30 meeting regarding district readiness to welcome Kindergarten families on 10/5 based on our reopening framework. Be it also resolved that any decision is contingent on the release of weekly state metrics due in the evening of 9/30. Be it also resolved that the district will provide an email communication and robocall to Kindergarten families no later than 12 pm on 10/1. - *Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau*
10. **School Committee Resolution** Be it resolved that the School Committee make a go or no-go decision using our approved reopening framework a minimum of 1 week prior to the start of every staggered hybrid phase. Be it also resolved that any decision is contingent on the release of weekly state metrics due on Wednesday evenings. Be it also resolved that the district will

provide an email communication and robocall to impacted families no later than 12 pm on Thursday prior to the hybrid start date. - *Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau*

11. School Committee Resolution: Condolences

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Michael Barry. Mr. Barry was the brother of retired teacher Maryanne Trane and late Columbus Elementary School Principal Jean Barry-Sutherland

School Committee Resolution

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Anthony Vozzella. Mr. Vozzella was the grandfather of Suzanne Hennessy, art teacher at the McGlynn Middle School.

School Committee Resolution

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Kathryn Gorman Rodrigues, sister of former School Committee Member Erin DiBenedetto and mother of Mr. David Rodrigues, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn's Chief of Staff.

School Committee Resolution

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Rosalie J. DelVecchio, a former substitute teacher at the Medford Public Schools.

School Committee Resolution

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Francis Xavier Sheehan, father of Mark Sheehan, a custodian at the Andrews Middle School.

XI. Negotiations and Legal Matters- Executive Session

To discuss all collective bargaining matters:

- Union Contracts
- Non-Union Contracts